BANGLADESH DEVELOPMENT 1990 - 2020

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Bangladesh on the Eve of Independence

- Bangladesh, devastated during 1971 genocide and war of liberation was described as a “basket case” by Henry Kissinger
- GDP of the first two years were negative.
  - ✓-6.83% in 1971
  - ✓-14.74% in 1972
- Poverty rate was 70%
- Economy was dependent on rain-fed agriculture
- Only 61% (by 1981 census) found work at market wages

BANGLADESH ON THE EVE OF INDEPENDENCE

Other indicators:

- **Population Growth Rate -2.6%**
- **Life Expectancy – 42 Years**
- **Infant mortality rate beyond the age of 5 – 239 out of 1000**
- **Literacy Rate – 24.3% (Female Literacy- 14.8%)**
  - ✓ **Primary Enrollment rate – 60% (Girl enrollment- 41%)**
  - ✓ **Secondary Enrollment – 18.1% (Girl enrollment- 7.9%)**
- **Rural and urban were isolated worlds, where urban areas consisted of 7.7% of the population**

DEVELOPMENT IN BANGLADESH

After 48 years:

- **Poverty reduced to 21.8%**
- **Food production tripled to 35 million MT**
  BD self sufficient in food production with 2.6m MT surplus
- **Population growth reduced to 1.1%**
- **Irrigation, mechanization and modern farming practices altered the agricultural landscape**
- **RMG turning into a $32 billion export sector in 2018 from a late 70s base of a few million dollars**

POVERTY TRENDS IN BANGLADESH 1990-2019

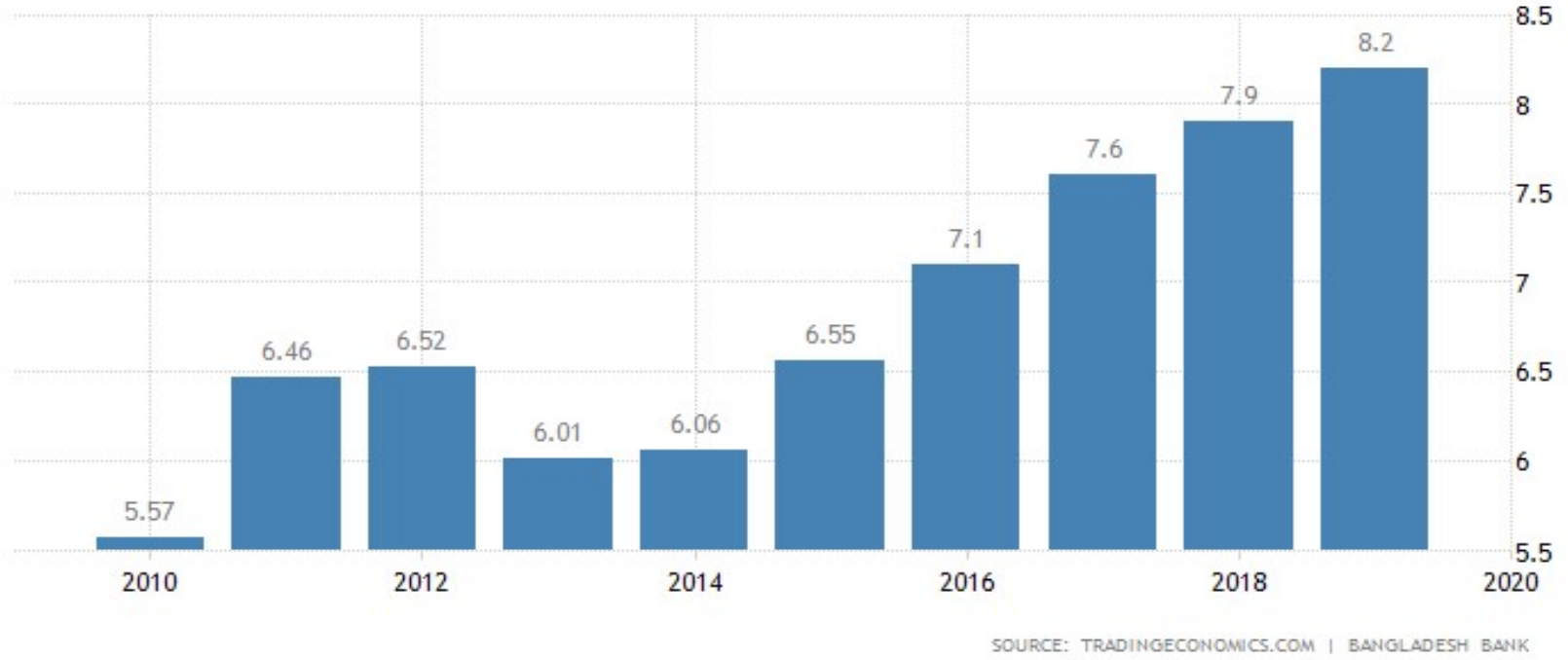
Bangladesh experienced impressive & steady poverty reduction from 49% in 2000 to 24.3% in 2017 21.8% in 2019

Extreme poverty declined from 34.3% in 2000 to 14.8% in 2017 and 9.2 % in 2019

In parallel, life expectancy, literacy rates and per capita food production have increased significantly

GROSS DOMESTIC PRODUCT (GDP) Annual Growth Rate

Average GDP growth has been increasing steadily from 5.57% in 2010 to 7.9% and 8.2% in the last two years



In 2018, Bangladesh fulfilled all three eligibility criteria for graduation from the UN's Least Developed Countries (LDC) list for the first time and is on track for graduation in 2024.

DEVELOPMENT IN BANGLADESH

- Services and migration-linked remittances are contributing to GDP growth rates that are currently in excess of 6%
- The rural-urban divide has given way to a rural-urban continuum
- An extensive system of safety net programs has virtually eliminated post-disaster secondary cycles of death and hunger
- Known as a disaster-management role model on the global stage
- Average number of children born per women has come down from 6.9 to 2.1

DEVELOPMENT IN BANGLADESH

- Life expectancy rose to 72 years (from the 1971 base of 42 years)
- Under-5 mortality rate reduced to 34 per 1000 live births
- Primary net enrolment ratio has risen to 89%
- Gender parity has been achieved not only at primary level but also at secondary level
  - ✓ Women are empowered by microcredit
  - ✓ The country's biggest export earner in the readymade garment sector, is overwhelmingly female.
- Nutrition looms large as an entrenched problem
- Despite the high levels, rates of stunting have declined steadily over the past 10 years, the undernutrition situation remains serious: 41%, or approximately 7 million, of children under five are stunted (low height for age), 14.3% are wasted (low weight for height) and 36.1% are underweight.

DEVELOPMENT IN BANGLADESH

- **The country has reduced its infant mortality rate tremendously, from 150 (per 1,000 live birth) in the early 1970s to 25.79 in 2019.**

- **Similarly the maternal mortality ratio has decreased from about 600 to 173 (per 100,000 live births) in 2019.**

- **Bangladesh's achievement in fertility control is even more dramatic. The total fertility rate has reduced from about 7.0 in the early 1970s to 2.03 in 2019.**

DEVELOPMENT IN BANGLADESH

- In mid-1980s only 2 percent of children were vaccinated. It climbed to 70 percent in a mere five years, which prompted Unicef to call it a 'near miracle.' The vaccination coverage is now more than 90%.

- Diarrhoea was a major killer of children and oral rehydration therapy (ORT) - the treatment of choice - was not available to the people. BRAC, with technical support from ICDDR,B carried out a decade-long arduous campaign to teach mothers how to prepare it from salt and molasses.

- Usage rate of ORT in Bangladesh is now the highest in the world and has become a part of the local culture in the sense that mothers transmit the knowledge to their next generation.

DRIVERS OF POVERTY REDUCTION

Economic factors:

- **The transition from a predominately agriculture based economy into a manufacture and service based economy**
- **The emergence and expansion of the RMG sector**
- **Occupational change within the labor force – movement from daily and self-employed work toward salaried jobs**
- **Growth in international remittance**
- **Productivity increases in agriculture**

DRIVERS OF POVERTY REDUCTION

Demographic factors:

- **Significant decline in average household size between 2000 (5.2) – 2016 (4.5)**
- **Increase in the share of adults per households indicating lower dependency rates and higher employment**
- **Steady increase of women participation in the labor force (from 25% to 35% between 2000-2010)**

Social sector:

- **Improvements in Education, Health, Nutrition**
- **Expansion of social safety nets**

CHANGES IN MORTALITY

Primary contributing factors to child surviving:

- **vaccines, adequate nutrition and basic medical and maternal care**

Other crucial contributing factors to child surviving:

- **improvement in education, access to clean water and adequate sanitation, adequate food, child protection and women's empowerment**

MILENNIUM DEVELOPMENT GOALS

September 2000, UN Millennium Summit, NYC

Millennium Declaration - adopted by 189 nations

by 2015 - achieve 8 time-bound targets to reduce extreme poverty

These targets became the Millennium Development Goals

MILLENIUM DEVELOPMENT GOALS



MDG ACHIEVEMENTS: BANGLADESH

Goal 1 Eradicate Extreme Poverty & Hunger

With sustained GDP growth rate of over 6%, the MDG target of halving the population living under the poverty line from 56.7% in 1990 to 24.9% (target was29%) was achieved by 2012, three years ahead of the target date

Goal 2: Achieve Universal Primary Education

Net Enrolment Ratio: from 60.55 in 1990 to 98% in 2015

Bangladesh was well ahead of regional neighbors, except India and Nepal

Literacy rate: Bangladesh was better than India and Pakistan along with other South Asian counterparts except Maldives and Sri Lanka.

MDG ACHIEVEMENTS: BANGLADESH

Goal 3: Promote Gender Equality and Empower Women

Bangladesh has been maintaining gender parity at secondary education level.

Gender parity at secondary level is highest in Bangladesh, followed by Maldives, Bhutan, Sri Lanka and Nepal.

Goal 4: Reduce Child Mortality

under-five mortality rate per 1000 live births decreased from 146 in 1990 to 36 in 2015 (target was 48)

The under-five mortality rate per 1000 live births in Bangladesh is lower than that of India and Pakistan. Bangladesh also performed better than India and Pakistan in case of infant mortality and children 1 year old immunized against measles.

MDG ACHIEVEMENTS: BANGLADESH

Goal 5: Improve Maternal Health (not achieved)

Maternal mortality per 100,000 live births 574 at 1990 to 176 in 2015; target was 143

Goal 6: Combat HIV/AIDS, Malaria and Other Diseases (partially met)

Prevalence of Malaria per 100,000 Population 776.9 in 1990; 434 in 2015 target was 310.8

Deaths from Malaria per 100,000 Population 1.4 in 1990; 0.34 in 2014 target was 0.6

MDG ACHIEVEMENTS: BANGLADESH

Goal 7: Ensure Environmental Sustainability

Improved Drinking Water Sources Bangladesh's performance is impressive comparing to India and Pakistan.

Access to improved sanitation, Bangladesh has been doing better than Afghanistan, India, Nepal, Bhutan and Cambodia.

Despite positive picture in afforestation, extensive clearing of forests for agriculture, homestead and other non-forest purpose thwart attaining of the target

Goal 8: Develop a Global Partnership for Development

CHALLENGES FOR BANGLADESH

- Bangladesh needs to create more and better jobs for the 2 million youths entering the job market every year.
- Low access to reliable and affordable power
- Poor transportation infrastructure
- Rapid urbanization
- Vulnerability to climate change and natural disasters
- Political interference and Poor governance



SDGs: 17 Goals, 169 Targets, 230 Indicators

SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9-xdy1Jr2eg